



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*yo devi divase śaṣṭhe prathamam samupaiti mām |
sa āhāro mama purā vihito lokakarṭṛbhiḥ || 41 ||
so 'yaṁ mama mahābhāge śaṣṭhe 'hani girīndraje |
brahmaṇā vihito nūnam nainam mokṣye kathamcana || 42 ||
yanmayā himavacchr̥ṅge caritam tapa uttamam |
tena bālamimam muñca grāharāja namo 'stu te || 43 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 12, Verses 41-43

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verses from the Skandapurāṇa paint a beautiful scene of divine intervention and devotion. We find the Goddess, likely Parvati, speaking of a momentous occasion occurring on the sixth day of a celebration, perhaps a festival dedicated to Shiva. She states that whatever offering comes to her first on that sixth day, is considered a sacred sustenance, ordained by the creators of the world themselves. This is not mere food; it is a divine gift, a manifestation of grace.

The Goddess continues, declaring that this particular offering, presented on the sixth day atop the King of Mountains, Himavan, has been ordained by Brahma himself. She vows never to relinquish it. This signifies the immense importance and sanctity attached to the offering. It's not just about the physical object, but the intention, the devotion, and the cosmic significance it carries.

The final verse reveals a plea. The Goddess speaks of the great penance she performed on the peaks of Himavan. She then uses the merit earned from that profound austerity to request the release of a child from the clutches of a Graharaaja, a king of aquatic beings, perhaps a crocodile or a similar creature. She offers her respect and implores for the child's freedom. This demonstrates the power of accumulated spiritual merit, the ability to use one's spiritual strength to alleviate suffering and effect positive change in the world.

How can you apply this in your own life? Recognize that every offering, whether material or of your time and energy, carries a weight of intention. Approach your actions with mindfulness and devotion, understanding that even the smallest gesture can be a sacred act. Remember the power of your own spiritual practice. Through consistent effort and unwavering devotion, you can accumulate spiritual merit, a reservoir of strength that can be used to overcome obstacles and bring about positive change, not only in your life but also in the lives of others. Just as the Goddess used her penance to save the child, your dedication can be a source of healing and liberation.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small act of devotion can you offer today, and how can you infuse it with the intention of alleviating suffering in the world around you?